

Why good leaders make you feel safe | Simon Sinek | TED

TED

좋은 리더는 안전감을 준다 — 사이먼 사이넥의 리더십 철학

Intermediate

11:59

DURATION

155

WPM

187

SEGMENTS

20

VOCABULARY

10

GRAMMAR



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01 Video Structure Overview

This 11-minute video by TED is structured into 8 key sections.

1 Captain Swenson's Medal of Honor

0:00 ~ 1:58

사이먼 사이넥이 아프가니스탄에서 부상병을 구하기 위해 실탄이 오가는 속으로 뛰어든 캡틴 윌리엄 스웬슨의 이야기로 시작해요. 고프로 카메라가 스웬슨이 부상병에게 입맞춤하고 다시 구조하러 돌아가는 장면을 담았어요. 이 강렬한 이미지가 질문을 던져요: 이런 이타적인 사랑은 어디서 오는 걸까?

Captain Swenson received the Congressional Medal of Honor

He ran into live fire to rescue the wounded

A GoPro captured his tender moment with a wounded soldier

Sinek asks: where do people like that come from?

2 Environment, Not Better People

1:58 ~ 2:39

사이넥은 자기 희생을 보상하는 군대와 타인의 희생을 보상하는 비즈니스를 대비해요. 처음에는 군인 영웅들이 그냥 더 나은 사람이라고 생각했지만, 진짜 답은 환경이라는 걸 배웠어요. 올바른 환경이 갖춰지면 모든 사람에게 놀라운 이타심의 능력이 있어요.

Military gives medals for self-sacrifice; business gives bonuses for sacrificing others

It's not about better people — it's about the environment

The right environment unlocks everyone's capacity for remarkable things

3 Trust and Cooperation Are Feelings

2:40 ~ 3:19

그가 인터뷰한 영웅들은 모두 같은 말을 해요: '그들도 나를 위해 그렇게 했을 거야.' 신뢰와 협력은 감정이지 지시가 아니에요. 사람들에게 신뢰하라, 협력하라고 명령할 수 없어요 — 자연스럽게 내면에서 우러나와야 해요.

'They would have done it for me' — universal answer from heroes

Trust and cooperation are feelings, not instructions

You cannot command someone to trust you

4 The Circle of Safety: 50,000 Years of Evolution

3:20 ~ 4:12

5만 년 전으로 돌아가면, 인간은 사회적 동물로 진화했어요. 부족을 형성했는데, 이것이 '안전의 원'이에요. 소속감이 신뢰와 협력을 만들어냈어요. 안에 있는 사람들은 다른 사람이 위험을 감시해준다는 걸 알기에 밤에 잠들 수 있었어요. 신뢰 없이는 생존 시스템이 무너져요.

Humans evolved as social animals in a dangerous world

The 'circle of safety' concept: tribes where people felt they belonged

Safety produces trust and cooperation naturally

Without trust, the survival system fails

5 Modern Organizations Mirror the Paleolithic Era

4:13 ~ 5:12

현대 세계는 구석기 시대를 반영해요: 경제적 불확실성, 신기술, 경쟁 같은 외부 위협은 우리가 통제할 수 없는 상수예요. 유일한 변수는 조직 내부의 조건이에요. 리더가 가시적 결과보다 사람들의 안전을 우선시하면 놀라운 일이 일어나요.

External threats (economy, technology, competition) are uncontrollable constants

Internal conditions are the only variable — and that's where leadership matters

Leaders set the tone by putting people's safety first

6 Unsafe Leaders Create Unsafe Behavior

5:14 ~ 6:58

사이넥은 승객을 함부로 대한 항공사 직원의 이야기를 들려줘요 — 나쁜 사람이어서가 아니라 리더로부터 안전하다고 느끼지 못했기 때문이에요. 직원들이 리더십을 두려워하지 않는 사우스웨스트 항공과 대비해요. 훌륭한 리더십은 훌륭한 부모됨과 같아요: 기회, 교육, 훈육을 제공해서 사람들이 우리가 상상한 것 이상을 이룰 수 있게 하는 거예요.

Airline gate agent story: she mistreated passengers because she felt unsafe

Southwest Airlines succeeds because employees don't fear their leaders

Unsafe conditions force people to protect themselves from each other

Great leaders are like great parents — they help people grow

7 Three Cases: NextJump, Banking CEOs, Bob Chapman

6:59 ~ 9:57

세 가지 강력한 사례: 찰리 김의 넥스트점프 평생 고용 정책은 직원을 가족처럼 대해요. 불균형적 보너스를 받는 은행 CEO들은 숫자를 위해 사람을 희생시키며 리더십의 사회적 계약을 위반했어요. 배리-웨일러의 밥 채프먼은 2008년 불경기에 해고 대신 순환 휴직을 선택하며 '모두가 조금 고통받는 게 낫다'고 했어요 — 사기가 올랐고, 2천만 달러를 절약했으며, 직원들이 자발적으로 휴가를 교환했어요.

NextJump: lifetime employment, coaching instead of firing

Banking CEOs violated leadership by sacrificing people for personal gain

Bob Chapman chose furloughs over layoffs — 'all suffer a little'

Employees spontaneously traded furlough weeks to help each other

8 Leadership Is a Choice, Not a Rank

9:58 ~ 11:52

사이넥은 리더십은 선택이지 직급이 아니라고 선언해요. 진정한 리더는 권한을 가진 사람이 아니라 주변 사람을 돌보기로 선택한 사람이에요. 마지막에 먹은 해병대 장교 이야기로 마무리해요 — 부하들이 음식을 가져다줬어요. 리더가 먼저 가고, 먼저 위험을 감수하고, 먼저 희생하면, 사람들은 기꺼이 피와 땀과 눈물로 보답해요.

Leadership is a choice, not a rank

Authority is not the same as leadership

True leaders look after the people around them

Marine officer ate last — his men brought him their food

Leaders go first, take risks first, sacrifice first

02 Essential Vocabulary

Core words from the video that are high-value for learners.

ambush /'æmbʊʃ/ noun

a surprise attack by people lying in wait in a concealed position

매복 공격, 기습

Old French 'embusche' from 'embuscher' meaning 'to set an ambush, to hide in the bushes'

em- busch (bush, hiding place)

"The column came under ambush and was surrounded on three sides."

Related: ambushade, bushwhack, trap

sacrifice /'sækrɪfaɪs/ verb/noun

to give up something valued for the sake of something else regarded as more important

희생하다, 희생

Latin 'sacrificium' from 'sacer' (sacred) + 'facere' (to make)

sacr (sacred) + fic (make) -ice

"Who are willing to sacrifice themselves so that others may gain."

Related: sacred, sacrificial, sacrament

capacity /kə'pæsɪti/ noun

the ability or power to do, experience, or understand something

능력, 역량, 수용력

Latin 'capacitas' from 'capax' meaning 'able to hold much'

capac (hold, contain) -ity

"Every single one of us has the capacity to do these remarkable things."

Related: capable, incapacitate, capacious

cooperation /koʊ'pə'reɪʃən/ noun

the process of working together to achieve the same goal

협력, 협동

Latin 'cooperatio' from 'co-' (together) + 'operari' (to work)

co- oper (work) -ation

"It's this deep sense of trust and cooperation."

Related: cooperate, cooperative, operation

instruct /ɪnˈstrʌkt/ verb

to direct or command someone to do something; to teach

지시하다, 가르치다

Latin 'instruere' from 'in-' (upon) + 'struere' (to build, pile up)

in-

struct (build)

"I can't simply instruct two people to cooperate and they will."

Related: instruction, construct, structure

inherent /ɪnˈhɪərənt/ adjective

existing in something as a permanent, essential, or characteristic attribute

본질적인, 내재하는, 고유한

Latin 'inhaerere' from 'in-' (in) + 'haerere' (to stick)

in-

her (stick, cling)

-ent

"There are inherent benefits to this."

Related: inherently, adhere, coherent

obsolete /ˌɒbsəˈliːt/ adjective

no longer produced or used; out of date

쓸모없어진, 구식의

Latin 'obsoletus' past participle of 'obsolescere' meaning 'to fall into disuse'

ob-

sol (accustomed)

-ete

"A new technology that renders your business model obsolete overnight."

Related: obsolescence, obsolescent, disuse

tangible /ˈtæŋdʒɪbəl/ adjective

clear and definite; real; able to be touched or felt

실질적인, 만질 수 있는, 구체적인

Latin 'tangibilis' from 'tangere' meaning 'to touch'

tang (touch)

-ible

"To sacrifice their comforts and sacrifice the tangible results."

Related: intangible, tangent, tactile

disproportionate /ˌdɪsprəˈpɔːrʃənɪt/ adjective

too large or too small in comparison with something else; out of proportion

불균형적인, 비례하지 않는

Latin 'dis-' (apart, away) + 'proportionatus' (made proportional)

dis-

proportion (balance)

-ate

"With their disproportionate salaries and bonus structures."

Related: proportion, proportional, disproportionately

violated /ˈvaɪəleɪtɪd/ verb

to break or fail to comply with a rule or formal agreement; to treat with disrespect

위반하다, 침해하다

Latin 'violare' meaning 'to treat with violence' from 'vis' (force)

viol (force, violence)

-ate

"They have violated the very definition of leadership."

Related: violation, violate, violence

recession /rɪˈseʃən/ noun

a period of temporary economic decline during which trade and industrial activity are reduced

경기 침체, 불경기

Latin 'recessio' from 'recedere' meaning 'to go back, retreat'

re-

cess (go, yield)

-ion

"He was hit very hard by the recession."

Related: recede, recess, concession

furlough /ˈfɜːrlɒʊ/ noun

a temporary leave of absence, especially from military duty or employment

일시적 휴가, 순환 휴직

Dutch 'verlof' meaning 'leave of absence, permission'

fur-

lough (leave, permission)

"And so they came up with a furlough program."

Related: leave, sabbatical, layoff

morale /məˈræl/ noun

the confidence, enthusiasm, and discipline of a person or group at a particular time

사기, 의욕

French 'moral' meaning 'mental condition' from Latin 'moralis'

moral (spirit, mind)

-e

"And morale went up."

Related: moral, morality, demoralize

spontaneously /spɒnˈteɪniəsli/ adverb

in a way that is natural and without planning or prompting

자발적으로, 자연스럽게

Latin 'spontaneus' from 'sponte' meaning 'of one's own accord'

spont (free will)

-aneous + -ly

"And quite spontaneously, nobody expected."

Related: spontaneous, spontaneity

authority /əˈθɔːrɪti/ noun

the power or right to give orders, make decisions, and enforce obedience

권위, 권한

Latin 'auctoritas' from 'auctor' meaning 'originator, promoter'

auctor (originator)

-ity

"They are authorities. And we do what they say because they have authority over us."

Related: authorize, authoritarian, author

tirelessly /ˈtaɪərləsli/ adverb

in a way that shows great effort and energy that does not stop

지치지 않고, 꾸준히

Old English 'tire' (to become weary) + '-less' (without) + '-ly'

tire (become weary)

-less + -ly

"And work tirelessly to face the dangers outside."

Related: tireless, tired, untiring

comrade /'kɒmreɪd/ noun

a companion who shares one's activities or is a fellow member of an organization

동료, 전우

Spanish 'camarada' meaning 'roommate' from Latin 'camera' (room)

camar (room, chamber)

-ade

"It shows Captain Swenson and his comrade bringing this wounded soldier."

Related: camaraderie, companion, fellow

03 Additional Vocabulary

Supplementary words that appear in the video and are useful for expanding your vocabulary.

medevac /ˈmedɪvæk/ noun

the evacuation of military or other casualties to a hospital, especially by helicopter

의무 후송, 응급 환자 수송

Blend of 'medical' and 'evacuation,' coined during the Korean War era

med (medical) + evac (evacuation)

"He and a comrade were making their way to a medevac helicopter."

Related: evacuate, medic, airlift

Paleolithic /ˌpeɪliəˈlɪθɪk/ adjective

relating to the early phase of the Stone Age, lasting about 2.5 million years

구석기 시대의

Greek 'palaaios' (old, ancient) + 'lithos' (stone)

paleo (ancient) + lith (stone) -ic

"If you go back 50,000 years to the Paleolithic era."

Related: paleontology, Neolithic, monolith

visceral /ˈvɪsərəl/ adjective

relating to deep inward feelings rather than to the intellect; instinctive

본능적인, 직감적인, 내장의

Latin 'viscera' meaning 'internal organs, inner parts'

viscer (internal organs) -al

"This is the reason so many people have such a visceral hatred."

Related: eviscerate, viscerally, gut feeling

04 Grammar Patterns

Key grammar structures used in the video. Each pattern includes real examples.

There's + noun phrase (existential 'there')

Used to introduce the existence of something or someone new into a conversation. It draws attention to the subject that follows.

'There's + 명사구'는 대화에서 새로운 존재를 소개할 때 사용해요. 뒤에 오는 주어에 청중의 관심을 끌어요. '~이 있어요'라는 의미예요.

There's a man by the name of Captain William Swenson.

There's a love there.

Who/that + relative clause (defining relative clause)

Relative clauses beginning with 'who' or 'that' provide essential information about the noun they modify. They define or identify the person or thing being talked about.

'who/that + 관계절'은 수식하는 명사에 대한 필수적인 정보를 제공해요. 말하고 있는 사람이나 사물을 정의하거나 식별해요.

Who recently was awarded the Congressional Medal of Honor.

Who are willing to sacrifice themselves so that others may gain.

People who are at the bottoms of organizations who have no authority.

So that + clause (purpose clause)

Used to express the purpose or reason for an action. It answers the question 'why?' and connects the action to its intended result.

'so that + 절'은 행동의 목적이나 이유를 표현할 때 사용해요. '~하기 위해서'라는 의미로, 행동과 의도된 결과를 연결해요.

Who are willing to sacrifice themselves so that others may gain.

They sacrificed their people to protect their own interests.

So that their people may be safe and protected.

What + clause as subject (nominal/noun clause)

A 'what' clause functions as the subject or complement of a sentence, replacing a noun. It adds emphasis and creates a dramatic or reflective tone.

'What + 절'이 문장의 주어나 보어 역할을 해요. 명사를 대신하며, 강조와 극적인 느낌 또는 사색적인 톤을 만들어요.

What is that? That is some deep, deep emotion.

What I learned is that it's the environment.

This is what so offends us, not the numbers.

If + present simple, present simple (zero conditional)

The zero conditional expresses general truths or habitual situations. When the 'if' condition is met, the result always happens.

영 조건문(zero conditional)은 일반적인 사실이나 습관적인 상황을 표현해요. 'if' 조건이 충족되면 결과가 항상 일어나요.

If you get the environment right, every single one of us has the capacity to do these remarkable things.

If we don't trust each other, that means you won't watch for danger.

If I don't follow the rules, I could get in trouble or lose my job.

Would + verb (hypothetical / narrative past future)

Used to express willingness, hypothetical situations, or future-in-the-past. In narrative context, it describes what someone was going to do or what would happen.

'would + 동사'는 의지, 가정 상황, 또는 과거 시점에서 본 미래를 표현해요. 이야기 맥락에서 누군가가 하려던 것이나 일어날 일을 설명해요.

Why would you do it?

Because they would have done it for me.

Would anybody be offended if we gave a 150 million dollar bonus to Gandhi?

The reason (why) + clause + is that + clause

A structure used to clearly state a cause-and-effect relationship. It frames the explanation by first identifying the reason, then providing it.

'The reason + 절 + is that + 절'은 인과 관계를 명확하게 설명하는 구조예요. 먼저 이유를 식별하고, 그 다음에 이유를 제공해요.

The reason we like flying Southwest Airlines is not because they necessarily hire better people.

This is the reason so many people have such a visceral hatred.

Comparative structure: It's better that... than...

Used to compare two options, expressing a preference for one over the other. Often used in persuasive or moral arguments.

'It's better that... than...'은 두 가지 선택지를 비교하며 하나를 선호한다고 표현할 때 사용해요. 설득이나 도덕적 논증에서 자주 쓰여요.

It's better that we should all suffer a little than any of us should have to suffer a lot.

Not A but B (contrast/correction structure)

Used to correct a potential assumption by negating one idea and presenting the true alternative. It creates a strong rhetorical contrast.

'Not A but B' 구조는 잘못된 가정을 부정하고 진짜 대안을 제시할 때 사용해요. 강한 수사적 대비를 만들어요. 'A가 아니라 B'로 해석해요.

But that's completely wrong. What I learned is that it's the environment.

It's not the numbers. It's that they have violated the very definition of leadership.

Leadership is a choice. It is not a rank.

We call them... because + clause (parallel repetition)

A rhetorical device using repetition to build emphasis and rhythm. The repeated structure reinforces the speaker's key point through accumulated examples.

반복을 통해 강조와 리듬을 만드는 수사적 기법이에요. 반복되는 구조가 축적된 예시를 통해 화자의 핵심 요점을 강화해요.

We call them leaders because they go first.

We call them leaders because they take the risk before anybody else does.

We call them leaders because they will choose to sacrifice.

05 Connected Speech & Pronunciation

Natural pronunciation patterns found in the talk. Practice these to sound more natural!

Linking (연음)

came under ambush → **케이먼더램부쉬** /keɪm_ʌndər_ˈæmbʊʃ/
'came'의 /m/이 'under'의 모음 /ʌ/와 매끄럽게 연결되고, 'under'의 /r/이 'ambush'의 /æ/와 이어져서 세 단어가 자연스러운 흐름을 만들어요.
'케이먼 언더 램부쉬'로 끊지 말고, '케이먼더램부쉬'처럼 자음과 모음을 연결해서 발음해 보세요.

fall asleep at → **폴러슬리펫** /fɔː l_əˈsliː p_ət/
'fall'의 /l/이 'asleep'의 /ə/와 연결되고, 'asleep'의 /p/가 'at'의 /ə/와 이어져요. 자음-모음 연결을 통해 각 단어가 다음 단어로 흘러가요.
'폴 어슬립 앳'으로 끊지 말고, '폴러슬리펫'처럼 한 덩어리로 발음해 보세요.

put him in → **푸리민** /pʊt_ɪm_ɪn/
'put'의 /t/가 'him'의 모음 앞에서 탄설음(flap)이 되고 ('h'가 탈락), 'him'의 /m/이 'in'의 /ɪ/와 연결돼요. 세 단어가 매끄럽게 연쇄해요.
'풋 힘 인'이 아니라 '푸리민'처럼 /t/를 가볍게 튕기고 세 단어를 이어 발음해 보세요.

Reduction (축약)

want to → **워너** /wɒnə/
빠른 말에서 'want to'는 '워너(wanna)'로 축약돼요. /t/가 탈락하고 'to'가 /ə/로만 남아요. 영어 구어에서 가장 흔한 축약 중 하나예요.
'원트 투'라고 딱박딱박 말하지 말고, '워너'처럼 자연스럽게 축약해서 발음해 보세요.

because they have → **비커즈 데이브** /bɪkəz ðeɪv/
'because'가 /bɪkəz/로 축약되고, 'they have'가 'they've' /ðeɪv/로 줄어 들어요. 'have'의 /h/가 완전히 탈락해요.
'비코즈 데이 해브'라고 강하게 발음하지 말고, 'because'의 첫 음절을 약하게 하고 'they've'로 축약해 보세요.

Assimilation (동화)

would you → **우쥬** /wʊdʒə/
'would'의 /d/와 'you'의 /j/가 구개음화를 통해 합쳐져서 /dʒ/ 소리가 돼요. 영어에서 전형적인 요드 합류(yod-coalescence) 현상이에요.
'우드 유'라고 분리해서 말하지 말고, '우쥬'처럼 /d/와 /j/를 합쳐 발음해 보세요.

Elision (탈락)

trust and cooperation → **트러스트 코아퍼레이션**

/trʌst_ən kəʊ,pə'reɪʃən/

'and'의 /d/가 자음 사이에서 탈락하여 /ən/으로 줄어들어요. 내용어 사이에 'and'가 올 때 자연스러운 발화에서 매우 흔한 현상이에요.

'트러스트 앤드'라고 /d/를 분명히 발음하지 말고,
'트러스트'처럼 /d/를 생략해 보세요.

next jump → **넥스점프**

/nɛks dʒʌmp/

'next'의 마지막 /t/가 'jump'의 /dʒ/ 앞에서 탈락해요. 파열음 군이 /t/로 끝나고 다른 자음이 뒤따르면 /t/가 흔히 생략돼요.

'넥스트 점프'에서 /t/를 빼고 '넥스점프'처럼 발음해 보세요. 더 자연스럽게 원어민처럼 들려요.

06 Signal Expressions

Key phrases used to structure the content. Learning these helps you follow presentations.

EMPHASIS

"There's a man by the name of Captain William Swenson"

구체적인 인물 이야기로 시작하며 청중의 관심을 끌어요

TRANSITION

"I saw this, and I thought to myself"

이야기에서 화자의 개인적 성찰로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"You know, in the military, they give medals to people"

군대와 비즈니스의 대비를 도입하며 핵심 논점을 제시해요

EMPHASIS

"But that's completely wrong"

앞선 가정을 강하게 부정하며 반전을 만들어요

EMPHASIS

"Because they would have done it for me"

영웅들의 공통된 대답으로 신뢰의 본질을 보여줘요 — 강연의 핵심 메시지

TRANSITION

"If you go back 50,000 years to the Paleolithic era"

시간적 맥락을 크게 전환하며 진화적 근거를 소개해요

TRANSITION

"The modern day is exactly the same thing"

과거 원시시대에서 현대로 연결하며 비유를 완성해요

EMPHASIS

"The only variable are the conditions inside the organization"

리더십의 역할을 강조하며 핵심 주장을 명확히 해요

TRANSITION

"The closest analogy I can give to what a great leader is"

리더십을 부모됨에 비유하며 새로운 관점을 제시해요

EMPHASIS

"This is what so offends us, not the numbers"

감정적 반응의 진짜 원인을 짚어주며 청중의 공감을 이끌어요

EMPHASIS

"Leadership is a choice. It is not a rank."

결론부의 핵심 명제로, 강연 전체를 하나의 문장으로 압축해요

SUMMARY

"We call them leaders because they go first"

반복 구조로 리더의 정의를 강화하며 감동적으로 마무리해요

Keep Learning!

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